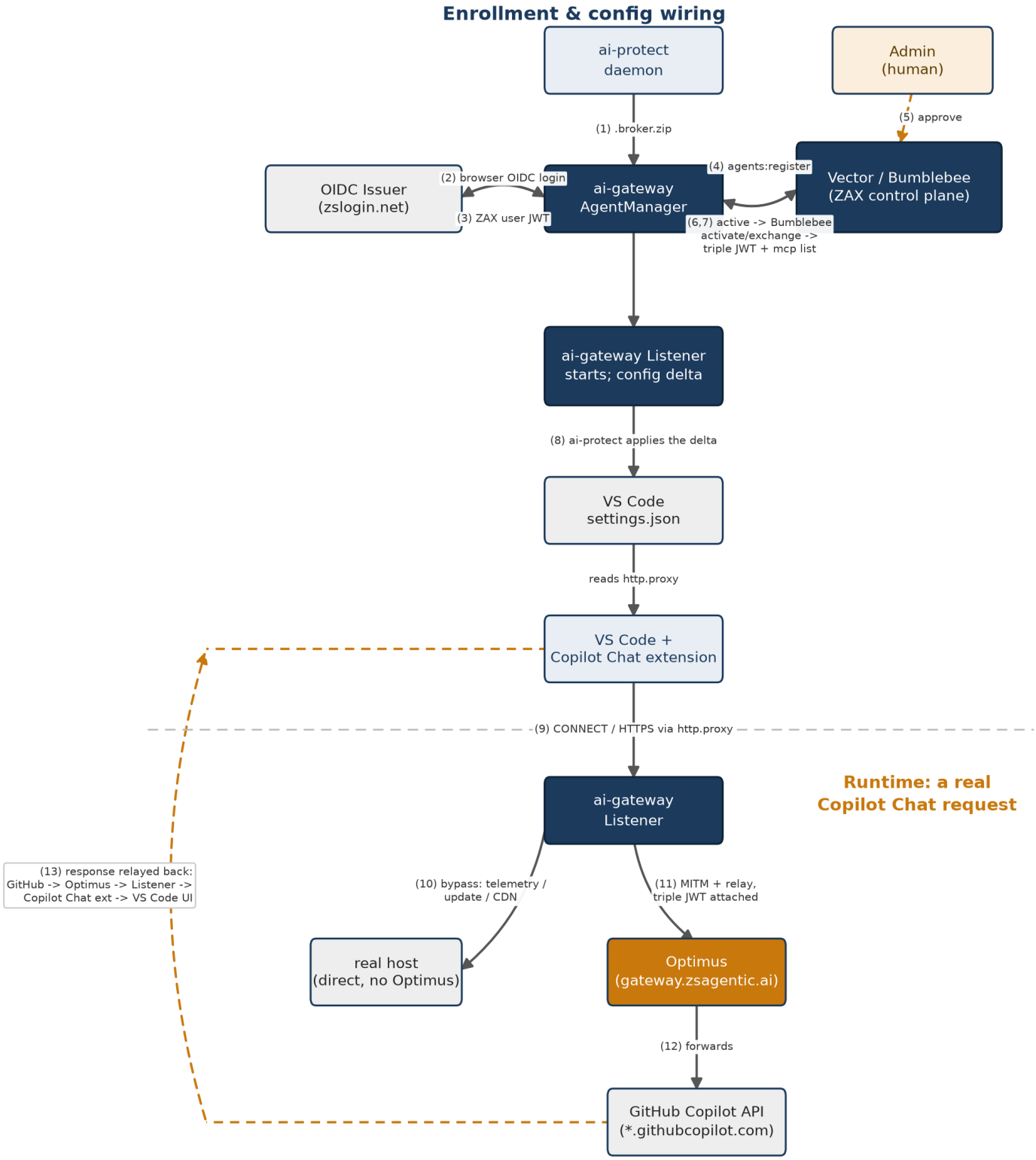
VS Code Copilot's four account modes, and why the shipped solution doesn't care which one a customer is on

2026-10-23. This builds directly on two existing docs rather than repeating them -- read those first for the full investigation history:

- **`../vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md`** -- the live account test that definitively closed the old `github-enterprise.uri` discovery-hijack lever for ordinary accounts, and the two-axis framing (GitHub hosting plan vs. Copilot billing tier) this doc reuses.
- **`../vscode-copilot-licensing-matrix.pdf`** -- the 8-row feasibility matrix (platform x account tier) for that same old mechanism, concluding 6 of 8 rows needed an unbuilt network-egress kernel hook.

What's new here: both of those docs were written against the `github-enterprise.uri` CAPI-discovery-hijack mechanism (`LlmRouting:: CopilotDiscoveryRelay`), which really is account-tier-gated (`enterprise: true`). This session shipped and live-proved a *different* mechanism (`LlmRouting::ForwardProxy`, `http.proxy`, full MITM via a locally-trusted CA) that is not. That changes the matrix's conclusion for 6 of its 8 rows.

Architecture: components and message flow



Regeneratable from `ai-testing/scripts/make_vscode_copilot_diagram.py` -- edit the `BOXES` / `ARROWS` data there and re-run it (see that script's header) rather than hand-editing the PNG.

Arrow-by-arrow detail

1. **ai-protect daemon -> `.broker.zip`**: discovery (`scan_inventory` + `collect_builtin_extensions`, Issue 4) recognizes VS Code and the built-in Copilot Chat extension; `discovered_broker_agents()` (Issue 5) now yields **both** `copilot` and `vscode-copilot` as candidates from that one signal. Writes the resolved tenant config (`cloud`/`oidc` from `init.yaml` or pushed settings, Issues 2/3) plus the discovered-agent list to `.broker.zip`.
2. **ai-gateway -> OIDC Issuer**: on seeing a usable tenant OIDC config, `AgentManager` opens a system browser to the issuer's authorize endpoint (PKCE). This is the **gateway's own** separate OIDC login -- distinct from ai-protect's device-plane enrollment (two separate backends; see the DVM runbook above).
3. **OIDC Issuer -> ai-gateway**: the issuer redirects back with an authorization code; the SDK exchanges it for tokens. The resulting ZAX user JWT feeds every backend call from here on.
4. **ai-gateway -> Vector**: `agents:register`, once per discovered agent id (here, both `copilot` and `vscode-copilot`) -- since the two share the same backend `agent_type`, this can resolve to one underlying registration (confirmed live: one approval covered both).
5. **Admin -> Vector**: a brand-new device/agent pair lands in `pending_approval` until an admin acts. This session used `zax-sdk-python/script/approve_agent.py` -- a real, interactive browser-based admin login -- against Vector's `/vector/v1/admin/ agent-operations/{id}/transition`.
6. **Vector -> ai-gateway**: the registration flips to `status: active`; `AgentManager`'s periodic `agents:status` poll (observed every ~10s) picks it up.
7. **ai-gateway -> Bumblebee -> Vector**: `/activations` (user JWT + agent identity -> instance JWT), then `/token-exchange` (instance JWT -> the triple JWT, carrying `intersected_caps`), then back to Vector's `/sdk/mcp-servers` for the MCP broker list.
8. **ai-gateway -> ai-protect -> VS Code**: the Listener starts and a config delta is computed; ai-protect's `.status.zip` watcher applies it -- for the `vscode-copilot` identity specifically, this writes `http.proxy` directly into VS Code's own `settings.json` (Issue 5's live confirmation).
9. **VS Code -> ai-gateway Listener**: the Copilot Chat extension's Electron fetcher reads `http.proxy` and routes *every* outbound HTTPS connection through it -- model calls, telemetry, update checks, and marketplace/CDN fetches alike, with no distinction at this layer.
10. **Listener -> real host, direct**: for a destination matching `BYPASS_HOSTS` (Issue 6) -- telemetry/update/CDN noise -- the Listener dials the real destination directly at the plaintext CONNECT stage, before any MITM, and splices raw bytes. This traffic never reaches Optimus (see the account-mode gap analysis above for which domains this does and doesn't cover yet).
11. **Listener -> Optimus**: for everything else, the Listener terminates TLS using its locally-trusted CA, reads the plaintext request, and relays it to Optimus (`gateway.zsagentic.ai`) over a fresh connection, attaching the triple JWT from step 7 as the request's credential.
12. **Optimus -> GitHub Copilot API**: Optimus forwards the request to the real upstream named in it (e.g. `api.business.githubcopilot.com`) -- this is also the one hop where Zscaler's own policy enforcement (DLP, visibility, model-use rules) actually acts, since it's the only point that sees real, decrypted traffic.
13. **GitHub Copilot API -> ... -> VS Code**: the response is relayed back along the exact same path in reverse, re-encrypted toward the client at the Listener, through the Copilot Chat extension, and rendered in VS Code's Chat panel. This exact sequence, for a real prompt, is what produced the clean response confirmed earlier in this doc.

The four modes, restated precisely

Per GitHub's own docs (see Sources) and the two existing docs above, "four modes" is really two independent axes, plus one mode (GHE.com) that moves along both:

#	Mode	Axis 1 -- hosting	Axis 2 -- Copilot billing	`enterprise:` flag
1	**Consumer**	ordinary multi-tenant `github.com`	Individual	`false` (confirmed live)

#	Mode	Axis 1 -- hosting	Axis 2 -- Copilot billing	`enterprise: true` flag
2	**Business**	ordinary multi-tenant `github.com`	Business seat	`false` (confirmed live, real seat)
3	**Enterprise**	ordinary multi-tenant `github.com`, Enterprise-account membership	Business or Enterprise seat	`false` (confirmed live, real membership)
4	**GHE.com**	dedicated `<slug>.ghe.com` instance (Enterprise Cloud w/ data residency)	Business or Enterprise only -- no Individual	Untested; "likely yes" per the matrix, never confirmed against a real tenant

Modes 1-3 all live on ordinary `github.com` and talk to the same model/API domain family (`*.individual|business|enterprise.githubcopilot.com` -- the plan name is baked into the hostname, confirmed against GitHub's own allowlist reference). **GHE.com is the only mode with a genuinely different network footprint**: almost everything -- auth, API, telemetry -- moves to `https://*.<slug>.ghe.com`, replacing the `github.com`-hosted endpoints entirely (`default.exp-tas.com` client-experimentation telemetry is dropped outright; Individual-plan routing isn't supported since GHE.com has no Individual tier).

Why the shipped mechanism doesn't need to know which mode it's on

`ForwardProxy` (`agents/vscode_copilot.rs`, `http.proxy` -> our listener -> full TLS MITM via a CA trusted machine-wide, confirmed live this session on the DVM through real Optimus, real OIDC, a real Vector-registered agent identity, and a real Copilot Chat response) operates at a layer below all four modes:

- **VS Code's `http.proxy` is Electron/Chromium-level**: it routes *every* outbound HTTPS connection the process makes through the configured proxy, unconditionally -- it has no concept of which GitHub account, billing tier, or hosting domain is involved. This is exactly the lever `vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md` Section 5 first found working (pass-through only, consumer/Business-seat account) -- this session matured it into full MITM + real backend wiring.
- **Our listener's CONNECT handling doesn't filter by destination either**: it mints a leaf certificate for whatever authority a client's CONNECT names and relays based on that, dynamically, per connection -- never a fixed domain list. A CONNECT to `api.business.githubcopilot.com:443` and one to `copilot-proxy.<slug>.ghe.com:443` are handled by the identical code path.
- **The old lever's gate (`enterprise: true`) never enters this path at all** -- it was specific to `defaultAccount.ts`'s discovery-URL derivation, a mechanism this product no longer uses for vscode-copilot.

Conclusion: for modes 1-3 (consumer, business, enterprise-member), the shipped mechanism is confirmed working and is not account-tier-gated in any way -- it directly supersedes the old matrix's "needs an unbuilt network-egress hook" verdict for 6 of its 8 rows (rows 1-3 and 5-7). No network-egress kernel hook (macOS `NETransparentProxyProvider`, Windows WFP redirect callout) is needed for these modes; `http.proxy` + MITM already does the job, proven live.

GHE.com (mode 4/8): reasoned, not yet live-verified

Nothing in the core interception mechanism depends on a fixed domain, so **the core MITM/relay itself should work identically for GHE.com** -- a CONNECT to any `*.<slug>.ghe.com` host is handled the same as any other authority. But two things are genuinely untested, not just theoretically fine, and shouldn't be asserted as working until a real GHE.com tenant is available:

1. **Whether GHE.com's sign-in/SSO flow tolerates being MITM'd at all.** Login/SSO flows sometimes carry extra TLS assumptions (certificate pinning, stricter transport checks) that ordinary API calls don't -- untested on *any* mode's sign-in in this session, since the DVM run used an already-enrolled identity end to end, not a fresh interactive Copilot sign-in through our proxy.
2. **Whether the `enterprise: true` flag matters for `ForwardProxy` at all.** It shouldn't (per the mechanism description above) -- but the old docs' matrix flagged real uncertainty about whether a genuine dedicated-instance sign-in even sets that flag, and `ForwardProxy` doesn't read it either way, so this is moot for us specifically. Noted only so a reader of the old matrix doesn't conflate the two mechanisms.

No Zscaler-controlled GHE.com tenant exists to test against directly (`vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md` Section 3, confirmed by Zscaler's own GitHub admin) -- closing this needs either a customer's real GHE.com tenant or a trial one.

The one real, concrete gap this session's work introduced: `BYPASS_HOSTS`

The core `ForwardProxy` mechanism generalizes cleanly (above). The **new non-MCP/non-LLM bypass feature** (`ai-gateway/listener/src/kinds/https.rs`, `BYPASS_HOSTS`, landed this session -- see `ISSUES.md` Issue 6 in this same folder) does **not**, and this is worth being precise about rather than asserting it generalizes when it doesn't:

- `BYPASS_HOSTS` is a hardcoded list keyed off hostnames observed on **one** consumer/Individual-tier account on **one** DVM session: `telemetry.individual.githubcopilot.com`, `update.code.visualstudio.com`, `main.vscode-cdn.net`, `mobile.events.data.microsoft.com`, `*.applicationinsights.azure.com`.
- GitHub's own allowlist reference names the model/API domains per-tier (`*.individual|business|enterprise.githubcopilot.com`) -- telemetry may well follow the same pattern (`telemetry.business.githubcopilot.com` for a Business account, untested), which `BYPASS_HOSTS` does not cover today.
- **GHE.com replaces essentially all of this list's domains** with `*.<slug>.ghe.com` equivalents (and drops `default.exp-tas.com` entirely) -- none of today's `BYPASS_HOSTS` entries would ever match a GHE.com tenant's traffic.
- **This fails safe, not open.** A host that doesn't match `BYPASS_HOSTS` simply takes the default path: full MITM, relayed through Optimus, same as the actual Copilot Chat traffic. Business/Enterprise/GHE.com telemetry we haven't enumerated yet doesn't leak around interception or break anything -- it's just not optimized off Optimus the way consumer-tier telemetry now is. Verified-safe, not verified-complete.
- **Follow-up, not urgent**: once a Business/Enterprise or GHE.com account is available to test against, capture its actual telemetry/update/CDN hostnames the same way this session captured the consumer-tier ones (`debug-service.log`'s `logical/eventual_target=` lines), and extend `BYPASS_HOSTS` -- the same two-options tradeoff documented at that constant's definition still applies to whatever gets added.

Summary

Mode	Core interception (`ForwardProxy`)	Optimus-bypass feature (`BYPASS_HOSTS`)
Consumer	**Confirmed working, live, this session**	**Confirmed working** for the domains this session observed
Business	Should work identically (domain-agnostic mechanism) -- not independently tested	Likely under-covers Business-tier telemetry hostnames (untested) -- fails safe to full MITM
Enterprise (member)	Should work identically -- not independently tested	Same gap as Business

Mode	Core interception (`ForwardProxy`)	Optimus-bypass feature (`BYPASS_HOSTS`)
GHE.com	Should work for the core MITM/relay (domain-agnostic) -- sign-in-flow TLS behavior genuinely untested, no tenant available	Does not cover `*.ghe.com` at all today -- fails safe to full MITM

Everything built this session, file by file

The account-mode analysis above is about one question (does the shipped mechanism generalize). This section is the complete engineering record behind "the shipped mechanism" -- every code file touched, what changed in it, and why -- so this doc stands on its own without needing `ISSUES.md` open side by side. `ISSUES.md` (this same folder) has the full narrative, live-log evidence, and exact line numbers for each; this is the condensed, file-oriented index.

Wiring vscode-copilot onto its own identity (pre-dates the numbered issues)

- **`ai-gateway/agent-manager/src/agents/vscode_copilot.rs`** -- `SPEC.llm` changed from `LlmRouting::CopilotDiscoveryRelay` (the `github-enterprise.uri` hijack this doc's first half is about -- confirmed a dead end for any ordinary sign-in) to `LlmRouting::ForwardProxy { proxy_key: "http.proxy", ca_env: &[], enabled: true }`. **Design**: the discovery-relay run through Optimus that originally proved real `/chat/completions` traffic could be routed used the `copilot` CLI adapter's identity as a stand-in, purely because it was already CONNECT-capable -- not because vscode-copilot should depend on it. A real customer has no reason to have the GitHub Copilot CLI installed, so vscode-copilot needed its own `ForwardProxy` identity instead of permanently borrowing `copilot`'s.
- **`ai-gateway/util/src/agent_configs.rs`** -- vscode-copilot's `shape` changed from `Shape::Llm(Llm::ProxyPath { path: &["github-enterprise.uri"], .. })` to `Shape::Llm(Llm::Scalars { proxy_key: Some("http.proxy"), .. })` -- the config-render side of the same move: write a flat `http.proxy` key into VS Code's own `settings.json` instead of the discovery-hijack path.

Listener observability (also pre-dates the numbered issues)

- **`ai-gateway/listener/src/kinds/mod.rs`** -- `forward()`'s log line rewritten to separate `logical/eventual_target` (what the request's Host/ CONNECT authority claims, labeled with its source) from `dial_target` / `resolved_dial_addr` (where the socket actually connected). **Design**: before this, one ambiguous field conflated "what this request is logically for" with "where the TCP socket went," which had already caused one real misreading earlier in this investigation (concluding Optimus was bypassed when it wasn't). This exact log format is what made Issue 5's and Issue 6's live verification possible -- without named `dial_target`, there'd be no way to tell a bypassed connection from a relayed one by log inspection alone.
- **`ai-gateway/listener/src/gateway.rs`** -- added `Destination:: resolve_with_source()` (names which of 4 sources supplied a destination: CONNECT authority, configured override, request-line authority, or the `Host` header) and `Gateway::last_dial_addr()` / `authority()` accessors backing the log line above.

Issue 3 -- `client_id` never merged into the tenant's OIDC config

- **`src/subscribers/ai_broker_launch.rs`** -- `InitOidc` gained a `client_id` field; `tenant_from_with` / `tenant_from_init` now merge it with the same settings-wins/`init.yaml`-fills-the-gap rule already used for `issuer`. New test: `client_id_follows_the_same_override_rule`. **Design**: the merge function structurally could not populate `client_id` from either layer before this -- `Oidc { issuer: ..., ..Oidc::default() }` always left every other `Oidc` field blank regardless of what was supplied, and the one correct fallback (`"zax.client"`) lived one layer too late (in the request-builder, after the usability gate had already failed and logged). The fix adds the missing merge rather than moving the fallback earlier, so the gate observes the same value the eventual request would use.

Issue 4 -- VS Code's built-in Copilot Chat extension was invisible to discovery

- **`src/tasks/ide/vscode.rs`** -- new `collect_builtin_extensions()`, wired into `find_extensions()`'s existing cache-population loop alongside `collect_extensions()`. Three new tests: `a_builtin_extension_is_found_without_an_extensions_json_entry`, `a_builtin_extension_under_a_hash_named_update_subdir_is_found` (the real layout), `a_malformed_builtin_entry_is_skipped`. **Design**: the existing `collect_extensions()` only ever read `<editor>/extensions/extensions.json` -- the marketplace-install catalog -- because that was the only install shape this module knew about. VS Code 1.142 ships `github.copilot-chat` as a *built-in*, bundled inside the app's own install directory, which is never registered in that catalog at all; built-ins and marketplace extensions are two separate tracking mechanisms in VS Code itself. The fix adds a second, parallel collection pass reading `package.json` directly out of the install directory, producing the identical `Extension` shape so every existing/future `find_extensions()` caller benefits with no per-agent special case -- deliberately not generalized beyond stock VS Code on Windows yet (see the account-mode table above for the parallel per-account-tier gap this leaves).
- First attempt also assumed `resources/app/extensions` sits directly under the install root; live-checked wrong -- Windows' background updater stages the real build under an opaque hash-named subdirectory instead, sometimes two of them coexisting after an in-place update. Fixed by checking both layouts.

Issue 5 -- `vscode-copilot` never got a chance to enroll under its own identity

- **`src/subscribers/ai_broker_launch.rs`** -- `discovered_broker_agents()` now pushes `"vscode-copilot"` as a *second* candidate whenever a folder's label is `"vscode"`, alongside whatever `client_label_to_broker_id` already returns (`"copilot"`, unchanged). Added `sources_for("vscode-copilot")` (identical hints to `"copilot"` -- same signal, different identity) and registered it in the `ALL_BROKER_IDS` test fixture so the existing completeness tests cover it automatically. **Design**: `client_label_to_ broker_id` deliberately folds VS Code's presence into the `copilot` CLI id (a real, intentional design for that function's own purpose). The gap was that this was the *only* path -- nothing ever gave `vscode-copilot` a chance to enroll under its own identity, so even with Issues 3/4 both fixed, a real end-to-end enrollment landed its config deltas in `~/.copilot/ settings.json` (the CLI's file), never VS Code's own `settings.json`. The fix doesn't change the existing `copilot` mapping at all -- it adds `vscode-copilot` as an additional, independent candidate from the same signal, so both identities get to enroll from the same VS Code install.

Issue 6 -- Optimus bypass for non-MCP, non-LLM traffic

- **`ai-gateway/listener/src/kinds/https.rs`** -- `BYPASS_HOSTS` const + `should_bypass_optimus()`, checked at the plaintext CONNECT stage (before any MITM) in `sniff_inner`. Three new tests covering exact match, subdomain match, and the dot-boundary guard against a false-positive substring match.
- **`ai-gateway/listener/src/server.rs`** -- `Prepared` gained a `bypass_to` field and a `Prepared::bypassed()` constructor; `serve_with_prepare` checks it before TLS accept or HTTP serving even start; `splice_bypassed()` / `dial_direct()` do the actual direct dial + raw `copy_bidirectional` relay. Three new tests (loopback dial success/failure, and an end-to-end splice proving bytes relay unmodified in both directions).
- **Design -- two options were considered, both documented in full at `BYPASS_HOSTS`'s own definition in the code**: 1. Client-side: write `http.proxy`'s sibling, `http.noProxy`, into VS Code's `settings.json` naming these hosts. 2. Server-side (chosen): bypass at the plaintext CONNECT stage, before any MITM, splicing raw bytes directly to the real destination. Chosen (2) because it's one list to maintain at the point traffic is actually observed (rather than one layer removed, in `agent_configs.rs`), and because it sidesteps re-encrypting traffic the gateway was never going to act on -- this exact session's own capture showed a dropped tunnel + a client-reported `websocket.error` in this same traffic class (see Issue 5's live-confirmation bullet). Accepted tradeoff: bypassed traffic gets zero visibility/audit on our side -- deliberate for telemetry/update/CDN noise, and exactly why an LLM or MCP destination must never be added to the list. See the gap analysis above for why this list doesn't yet generalize across account modes the way the core mechanism does.

Issue 1 -- startup crash (still open, not part of this doc's scope)

`STATUS_STACK_BUFFER_OVERRUN` in `zscaler-ai-protect.exe`, ~50s after a fresh MSI install's first service start. Ruled out as an installer problem; not yet root-caused or confirmed reproducible. No code changed for this one this session -- see `ISSUES.md` Issue 1 for the full WER/event-log detail and the next steps (pull the WER dump, try to reproduce via a manual service restart).

Setting up a disposable VM to test this, step by step

Everything in this session ran against a real Windows disposable VM (DVM) -- no simulator, no fixture harness. This is the full runbook, gotchas included, so someone else can reproduce it without re-discovering each one live.

1. Connect to the DVM

- Confirm RDP is reachable: `Test-NetConnection -ComputerName <ip> -Port 3389`.
- Build a `.rdp` file (or use `mstsc` directly) with, notably: `authentication level:i:0` -- a self-signed/internal host fails cert validation at the default level (`i:2`), which surfaces as a generic "certification authority could not be contacted" error.
- Store credentials via Windows Credential Manager (`cmdkey`), never in plaintext in the `.rdp` file -- or set `prompt for credentials:i:1` to type the password each time instead, if you'd rather not persist it at all.

2. Share this repo into the session

- On the host (your dev machine): `subst Z: "<path to this ai-protect checkout>"`. **Not persistent** -- resets on logoff/reboot; redo it if file sharing stops working.
- Add `drivestoredirect:s:Z:` to the `.rdp` file (or enable the matching drive in `mstsc`'s Local Resources tab). Inside the DVM this appears as `\\tsclient\Z\...`.
- PowerShell handles `\\tsclient\Z\...` paths natively -- no need to map a drive letter inside the DVM session itself.

3. Allow local scripts to run on the DVM

Default PowerShell execution policy blocks unsigned local scripts. As Administrator/an elevated account on the DVM, once:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope LocalMachine -Force
```

(`RemoteSigned` only blocks scripts *marked downloaded from the internet* -- anything copied over the shared drive runs fine. `Bypass` works too if you'd rather not think about the distinction.)

4. Build and get the MSI onto the DVM

From the dev machine:

```
gh workflow run adhoc-build.yml --ref <branch> -f os=windows -f version=<X.Y.Z> -f environment=staging
gh run list --workflow=adhoc-build.yml --limit 3      # get the run id once it starts
gh run download <run-id> -n zscaler-ai-protect-msi-x64 -D .
```

- **`environment` must match whatever backend your test tenant actually exists on** -- see step 6. `staging` and `dev` both dispatch immediately; **`prod` requires a GitHub Environment-protection admin approval and will sit `in_progress` indefinitely** without one -- avoid it for fast iteration unless you specifically need a prod-baked binary and have an approver.
- Copy the downloaded `.msi` onto the DVM via the shared drive from step 2.

5. Install -- the two gotchas that cost the most time this session

```
msiexec /i "C:\full\absolute\path\to\the.msi" /L*V "C:\full\absolute\path\to\install.log"
```

- **Must run elevated.** The service install needs `LocalSystem` privileges; a non-elevated run doesn't partially install -- MSI's transactional rollback undoes *everything*, leaving zero trace (no ARP entry, no files, no service). Confirm elevation first:
  `([Security.Principal.WindowsPrincipal][Security.Principal.WindowsIdentity]::GetCurrent()).IsInRole([Security.P`
- **Must use the full absolute path, never a relative one** (`.\the.msi`). A relative path produces `Error 1324: The folder path '.' contains an invalid character` and a near-instant, silent failure (`MainEngineThread is returning 2`) -- no UI, no obvious error, just nothing installed.
- Always pass `/L*V <logfile>` -- cheap, and the only way to diagnose a failure after the fact. The log is UTF-16; decode with `iconv -f UTF-16LE -t UTF-8` or just `Get-Content` in PowerShell (which handles the encoding automatically).

6. Verify the install landed

Copy `scripts/verify-msi-install.ps1` (from this repo's own root, over the shared drive) onto the DVM and run it:

```
.\verify-msi-install.ps1 *>&1 | Out-File -FilePath 'C:\some\local\path\verify.txt'
```

Use `*>&1`, not a plain `|` -- the script's PASS/FAIL lines are `Write-Host`, which bypasses the normal output pipe entirely; a plain `| Out-File` would silently capture almost nothing.

7. Enroll the device

Launch the installed app's enrollment UI and sign in -- either SSO (org/ tenant slug) or an enrollment token. **The org/tenant must actually exist on the backend your binary's `environment` was baked against** (step 4) -- a real, correct-looking slug still fails with *"We couldn't sign in to 'X'. Check your organization name..."* if it exists on a different environment's backend than the one this binary points at. If SSO fails, don't assume the slug is wrong before confirming which environment the tenant actually lives on.

8. Get the ai-gateway broker itself authenticated

Device enrollment (step 7) and the gateway's own authentication are **two separate backends** -- enrolling the device does not by itself give the gateway (the process that actually talks to Vector/Bumblebee/Optimus) anything to authenticate with. If the real backend doesn't push `settings.ai_gateway.{cloud,issuer,client_id}` for your tenant (checkable: `debug-service.log` repeating `"the snapshot carried no usable OIDC config"`), supply it locally instead:

As the **non-admin user the gateway runs as** (not the admin account):

```
@"
cloud: prod
oidc:
  issuer: https://<your-oidc-issuer>/
  client_id: zax.client
"@ | Set-Content -Path "$env:USERPROFILE\.zsai-gateway\init.yaml" -Encoding ascii -NoNewline
```

- **`-Encoding ascii`, not `utf8`.** Windows PowerShell 5.1's `utf8` encoding writes a BOM, which breaks the YAML parser (`"deserializing from YAML containing more than one document is not supported"` -- a confusing error for what's really just a stray BOM). `ascii` is safe since this content has no non-ASCII characters.
- Then, as Administrator, `Restart-Service zscaler-ai-protect` to make the daemon recompute and push a fresh snapshot to the gateway.

- **After *any* reinstall or restart, verify the gateway process is actually running fresh code** -- an MSI upgrade cannot restart the gateway/UI processes itself (Windows Restart Manager logs `Event 10010`: *"Application SID does not match Conductor SID"*, since `msiexec` runs elevated while the gateway runs as the ordinary user). Check: `powershell Get-Process zscaler-ai-gateway -ErrorAction SilentlyContinue | Select-Object Id, StartTime` If it's missing, or its `StartTime` predates the new binary's `LastWriteTime`, force a respawn: `Stop-Process -Name zscaler-ai-gateway -Force`, then `Restart-Service zscaler-ai-protect` again and re-check.

9. Approve the agent registration, if one lands in `pending_approval`

From the dev machine, `zax-sdk-python` repo, using its pre-built `.venv-approve` virtual environment:

```
.venv-approve/Scripts/python.exe script/approve_agent.py --agent-id <uuid-from-the-gateway-log>
```

- `script/admin.yaml` must point at the **same** `cloud` / `oidc.issuer` as the gateway's own `init.yaml` from step 8 -- it's a separate admin login against the same backend.
- This opens a **real interactive browser login** a human has to complete -- it can't be driven headlessly.
- `vscode-copilot` and the standalone `copilot` CLI identity register under the same backend `agent_type`, so one approval can cover both.

10. Where to look when something's wrong

What	Where	Run as
Daemon's own log	`C:\ProgramData\ZscalerAIProtect\daemon.log`	**Admin** -- this directory is ACL-hardened; a non-admin read silently finds "nothing" rather than an access-denied error
Gateway's own log	`$env:USERPROFILE\.zsai-gateway\logs\debug-service.log`	The gateway-owning user, not admin
VS Code's own wiring	`%APPDATA%\Code\User\settings.json`	either
`copilot` CLI identity's wiring	`~\.copilot\settings.json` / `mcp-config.json`	either -- useful to tell "`copilot` wired" apart from "`vscode-copilot` wired"
`.broker.zip`'s actual tenant (decompress)	`$env:USERPROFILE\.zsai-gateway\.broker.zip` gzipped JSON	the gateway-owning user

11. Getting command output back off the DVM efficiently

Pasting output back and forth over RDP is slow. Redirect straight to the shared drive from step 2 instead:

```
<command> *>&1 | Out-File -FilePath '\\tsclient\Z\out\whatever.txt' -Encoding utf8
```

(add `*>&1` whenever the command uses `Write-Host`, same caveat as step 6). That lands in `out/` on the host side -- gitignored, read it directly there rather than waiting for a copy-paste round trip. Use the single-quoted literal UNC path exactly as written; relaying it through an intermediate echo/heredoc step can mangle the leading backslashes.

12. VS Code + Copilot Chat on the DVM

```
winget install --id Microsoft.VisualStudioCode --exact --accept-package-agreements --accept-source-agreements
```

Installs per-user under `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Microsoft VS Code\`. Don't bother separately installing the `github.copilot-chat` marketplace extension -- modern VS Code ships it **built-in**, and a manual install attempt fails with

"cannot be downgraded" (expected, not a real error -- see Issue 4 above for why that confused this session's own detection code too).

The two purpose-built test scripts

Once everything above is done, `ai-protect/ai-gateway/scripts/windows/ agents/vscode-copilot/`:

- **`TestVscodeCopilotRealDaemon.ps1`** -- checks the gateway binary + service are present, installs VS Code/extensions if missing, pauses for interactive Copilot sign-in, then checks whether the real daemon already wrote `http.proxy` into `settings.json` on its own.
- **`DiagnoseVscodeCopilotProxy.ps1`** -- the deeper per-request check: proxy reachability, system-trust-store CA verification via `curl.exe`, then walks you through sending one real Copilot Chat message and checks the gateway log for it.

Appendix: full text of `vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md`

Reproduced in full below rather than just linked, since it's the live account-test evidence this doc's "four modes" analysis (above) leans on directly -- in particular Section 1/Section 3's confirmation that Zscaler has no dedicated GHE.com instance, and Section 5's confirmed-working `http.proxy` finding that this doc's `ForwardProxy`/Optimus mechanism builds on. Source file: `ai-testing/docs/vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md` (this folder's parent).

VS Code Copilot's `enterprise: true` gate -- account test against a real Zscaler-licensed account

Follow-up to `vscode-copilot-chat-extension.html`'s open risk (Section 6): whether a real customer account can ever satisfy the `enterprise: true` gate that activates the `github-enterprise.uri` CAPI-discovery hijack. That doc's own live tests never covered an account with a real Enterprise/Business license attached. This one does -- against `ukanitkar`, a real Zscaler-licensed GitHub account -- and also answers the broader question of what, if anything, can be done for customers who are on ordinary `github.com` with no GHE angle at all.

Bottom line: still `enterprise: false`, and now definitively so. A real Copilot Business seat and real Zscaler Enterprise membership were not enough to activate the mechanism. The one remaining untested path -- a genuine GHE.com sign-in -- is now **closed outright**: Zscaler's GitHub admin confirmed there is no dedicated GHE.com instance at all (Section 3). There is no further way to reach `enterprise: true` on this account through that route.

But a separate, non-account-gated lever was found live and confirmed working, 2026-10-13: VS Code's `http.proxy` setting routes all Copilot CAPI traffic, including real `/chat/completions` calls, through a proxy on this same ordinary (`enterprise: false`) account (Section 5 item 5). It's non-enforced (user-editable) and untested for full TLS termination, but it changes the answer for the ordinary-`github.com` population from "no known option" to "a real interim lever exists, with an enforced follow-up being designed" (`vscode-copilot-network-egress-redirect-design.md`).

1. What this account actually has

Checked directly on `github.com` and in VS Code's own local state:

- **`github.com/settings/enterprises`**: `ukanitkar` is a member of two Enterprise accounts -- `AIGateWayTeam` (Owner, 12-day trial -- the same self-provisioned trial from `github-copilot-app-interception-feasibility.md`, already known to have no path to Copilot Business/Enterprise at all) and `Zscaler` **(Member)** -- presumably the real employer-owned Enterprise account.

- **`github.com/settings/sso`**: only **`AIGuardOrg`** shows an active enforced SSO session. No row for `Zscaler` or `AIGateWayTeam` -- i.e. Zscaler's Enterprise does not appear to enforce SAML SSO on this account. This is itself informative: it suggests membership here is ordinary org/seat membership, not an SSO-gated enterprise session.
- **VS Code's `state.vscdb`** (`~/Library/Application Support/Code/User/globalStorage/state.vscdb`):
- `github.copilot-github` -> `ukanitkar` (confirms the signed-in identity).
- `extensionsAssignmentFilterProvider.copilotSku` -> `copilot_for_business_seat_quota` -- **confirms a genuine Copilot Business seat**, not the free/individual tier.
- `defaultAccount.cachedPolicyData` -> holds `policyData` (`chat_agent_enabled`, `chat_preview_features_enabled`, `mcp: false`, ...) but **no `enterprise` field, no enterprise-auth-provider object, nothing matching the `IDefaultAccountAuthenticationProvider` shape** `defaultAccount.ts` returns when `enterprise` is true.
- The wider model catalog in Copilot Chat's model picker (Claude Sonnet 5.5, GPT-6 Luna, GPT-6.1 Sol, etc.) is consistent with the Business-seat SKU finding -- it's evidence for the *license tier*, not for the `enterprise` auth-provider flag, which is a separate axis entirely.

Takeaway: a real Copilot Business seat + real Enterprise-account membership on ordinary `github.com` does **not** by itself flip `enterprise: true`. That flag tracks which `defaultAccountProvider` VS Code has registered internally, not your license/SKU or org membership.

2. The local behavioral test

Since `enterprise` is never persisted anywhere (confirmed by the `cachedPolicyData` check above -- it's computed fresh by `getDefaultAccountAuthenticationProvider()`, not cached or written to disk), the only way to observe it is behaviorally: configure `github-enterprise.uri` to point at a listener you control, sign in fresh, and see whether the discovery call (`GET /copilot_internal/user`) ever arrives.

Setup: - Built and ran `ai-gateway/gateway-simple` (binary: `ai-gateway-simple`) -- the existing test harness that implements exactly this relay: binds a loopback port, answers `/copilot_internal/user` with a real call to `api.github.com` then rewrites `endpoints.api` to point back at itself, and passes everything else through. - Pointed `~/Library/Application Support/Code/User/settings.json`'s `github-enterprise.uri` at that listener (`http://localhost:63956`). - Signed out of Copilot Chat in VS Code, then signed back in via **"Continue with GitHub"** (the ordinary OAuth flow, `github.com/login/oauth/authorize…`).

Result: zero requests ever reached the listener. Same outcome as every consumer account tested before this one.

A second, incidental finding from this test: VS Code's Copilot sign-in dialog has a **third button**, "Continue with GHE.com", alongside "Continue with GitHub" and "Continue with Google"/"Continue with Apple". Clicking it writes two settings automatically:

```
json "github-enterprise.uri": "https://<slug>.ghe.com", "github.copilot.advanced": { "authProvider": "github-enterprise" }
```

We tried manually pre-setting `authProvider: "github-enterprise"` ourselves (keeping our own `github-enterprise.uri` value) and then signing in via the *ordinary* "Continue with GitHub" button instead, to see if the override alone was enough without a real GHE tenant. It wasn't -- `authProvider` got silently reset back to `{}` by the time sign-in completed. That strongly suggests `authProvider` is **write-back state that reflects which flow you actually completed**, not a free-standing switch you can pre-set to change behavior. The only way to set it that "sticks" is to actually complete a GHE.com sign-in.

3. The GHE.com path -- closed, confirmed by Zscaler's GitHub admin

Guessed `zscaler.ghe.com` as the likely tenant slug and clicked "Continue with GHE.com" twice. Both times: `DNS_PROBE_FINISHED_NXDOMAIN` -- that specific hostname does not exist. That alone only ruled out one guessed slug, so the admin was asked directly whether a GHE.com tenant exists at all.

Admin's answer (2026-10-12):

> The current GitHub is SaaS multi tenant hosting Enterprise tier. While we dont have dedicated instance, the agreement is protected by agreement between ZS and MS.

This is a definitive answer, not just a failed guess: Zscaler is on ordinary **multi-tenant `github.com`** with an Enterprise plan, **no dedicated GHE.com instance at all**. The ZS/MS agreement referenced is a contractual/legal safeguard (data-processing / enterprise terms), not a technical multi-tenancy boundary -- it creates no separate sign-in flow and no distinct `defaultAccountProvider` the way a real GHE.com tenant would.

This also resolves the distinction that caused confusion mid-investigation:

- **"Zscaler" showing up under `github.com/settings/enterprises`** is an Enterprise *billing/admin* layer on top of ordinary `github.com` -- exactly what the admin confirmed. It never implied a GHE.com tenant.
- **GHE.com** is a distinct product (Enterprise Cloud with data residency) with its own dedicated subdomain. Zscaler is confirmed not to use it.

Net effect: the GHE.com sign-in path is closed for this account, not just untested. The one remaining candidate mechanism for a genuine enterprise-flavored sign-in -- one that doesn't require a dedicated instance -- is GitHub **Enterprise Managed Users (EMU)**, which runs on ordinary `github.com` but has its own SSO-only sign-in flow and a username suffix (e.g. `ukanitkar_zscaler`). The signed-in account here is plain `ukanitkar`, with no such suffix -- evidence against EMU being in use, but not yet confirmed directly. Follow-up question sent to the admin to settle this (Section 6).

Compliance note surfaced in the same reply

The admin's response also included an unprompted but important policy note:

> Please note, the Copilot is only approved for pilot with non-IP repos and we expect open source code usage during your testing/evaluation.

This matters directly for how this investigation (and any further testing) should be scoped: Copilot Chat is only approved against **non-IP / open-source repositories**, not Zscaler's own proprietary codebases. The testing in this doc was scoped to the sign-in/discovery-URL mechanism only -- no chat prompt was ever issued referencing proprietary repo content -- but this is worth treating as a hard constraint for any further testing, not a footnote: **do not issue real Copilot Chat prompts inside proprietary repos** (this one included) as part of this work. If further testing needs a real chat round-trip (not just the discovery call), it should happen against a non-IP/open-source repo instead.

4. "GitHub Enterprise" vs "Copilot Business/Enterprise" -- two different axes

Worth spelling out precisely, since conflating these two is exactly what caused confusion mid-investigation (Section 1's "real Business seat + real Enterprise membership" framing is easy to misread as one thing when it's actually two independent axes):

Axis 1 -- GitHub's own hosting/account plan (governs SSO/SAML, audit logs, advanced security, and *how* the org is hosted): - GitHub Free / Team -- ordinary multi-tenant `github.com`. - **GitHub Enterprise** (Cloud or Server) -- adds SSO/SAML, audit logs, policy enforcement, advanced security. Enterprise *Cloud* can be either ordinary multi-tenant hosting (what Zscaler has, confirmed Section 3) or a **dedicated `<slug>.ghe.com` instance** (what Zscaler confirmed it does *not* have).

Axis 2 -- GitHub Copilot's own subscription tier (a separate product, billed per seat, layered on top of whichever hosting plan the org has): - Copilot Individual -- personal. - **Copilot Business** ($19/user/month) -- centralized seat management, policy toggles (e.g. block suggestions matching public code), content exclusions. - **Copilot Enterprise**

($39/user/month) -- higher AI-request allowance, earlier access to new models, deeper customization (custom knowledge bases, Copilot Chat on github.com itself).

Per GitHub's own docs, Business and Enterprise are "the two Copilot plans for customers on GitHub Enterprise Cloud" -- an enterprise account picks one per organization. Worth verifying rather than assuming: whether a standalone non-Enterprise org (plain GitHub Team) can still buy Copilot Business on its own -- the docs found so far are scoped to the enterprise-account purchasing flow specifically, so this isn't confirmed either way from them alone.

Why this matters for this doc's core finding: Zscaler's actual setup -- real Enterprise-account membership (Axis 1, ordinary multi-tenant) **plus** a real Copilot Business seat (Axis 2) -- is exactly the combination tested live in Section 1-2, and `enterprise: true` stayed false. That's because VS Code's gate cares about **how the sign-in happened** (tied to Axis 1's hosting model -- specifically whether it's a genuinely GHE-flavored sign-in like a dedicated GHE.com instance), not which Copilot billing tier is active (Axis 2). A hypothetical upgrade to Copilot Enterprise alone, with no dedicated GHE.com instance, would very likely produce the same `enterprise: false` result -- the SKU doesn't touch the sign-in flow at all. This is also why the matrix in the shared licensing doc treats "License Needed" as a hosting-model question (dedicated GHE.com instance), never a Copilot-tier question.

Sources: - Choosing your enterprise's plan for GitHub Copilot - GitHub Copilot Business vs Enterprise: Choosing the Right Plan for Your Team

5. The broader question: customers on ordinary `github.com`, no GHE at all

Separately from testing this specific account: for a customer who is purely on `github.com` with no GHE angle whatsoever, the account-tier/sign-in-flow levers are closed -- but **one non-account-gated lever was found live this session and works today.** Status of every direct lever examined (`vscode-copilot-chat-extension.html` Section 2, plus the new finding):

1. **Extension debug settings** (`overrideProxyUrl` / `overrideCapiUrl`) -- confirmed ignored by `github.copilot-chat` (a filed GitHub issue shows this). Closed.
2. **Node-level `HTTPS_PROXY` / `NODE_EXTRA_CA_CERTS`** -- the mechanism every other adapter in this codebase relies on. Real user reports say the extension ignores `NODE_EXTRA_CA_CERTS`; Microsoft's own design doc (`agentHost/node/claude/CONTEXT.md`) confirms proxy support for chat/completion traffic via this specific path is "Deferred for later phases." Closed, but narrower than it first reads -- see #5.
3. **BYOK** (`chatLanguageModels.json`) -- strictly additive; registers a new selectable model alongside Copilot's own, can't redirect or intercept Copilot's default traffic. Closed.
4. **The `github-enterprise.uri` discovery hijack** (the mechanism this whole investigation is about) -- gated behind `enterprise: true`, which this doc confirms stays `false` for an ordinary sign-in, Business seat or not. Doesn't help this population.
5. **VS Code's `http.proxy` setting (the Electron fetch path) -- confirmed working, 2026-10-13.** The research that closed #2 only tested the Node `HTTPS_PROXY` / `NODE_EXTRA_CA_CERTS` path. The Copilot Chat extension defaults to Electron's own fetcher (`advanced.debug.useElectronFetcher` = true), which uses Chromium's proxy resolution -- i.e. VS Code's `http.proxy` setting -- not Node's env vars. Live-tested end to end on this `ukanitkar` account (ordinary `github.com`, Business seat, `enterprise: false`): with `"http.proxy": "http://127.0.0.1:<port>"` set and a pass-through CONNECT-logging proxy listening, **every CAPI and auth host routed through it** -- `api.github.com` (discovery/token), and the full `*.business.githubcopilot.com` family including a real `/chat/completions` call that returned a genuine model response. Zero direct (non-proxied) connections from any VS Code process. This is the first mechanism in this investigation confirmed to touch the actual chat/completions traffic on an ordinary, non-GHE account. - **Caveats, stated precisely:** only *routing* was tested (a pass-through proxy, no TLS termination) -- not full interception. The extension trusts the **system/login keychain** for TLS (`@vscode/proxy-agent`'s `loadSystemCertificates`), so a CA installed there should work for a real MITM relay, but that step was not run. The setting is also **user-editable, not enforced** -- anyone can delete it -- unless pushed via an MDM-managed VS Code settings profile, which would make it

semi-enforceable rather than a true kernel-level guarantee. Full write-up, architecture, and the Windows `ALE_CONNECT_REDIRECT`/macOS `NETransparentProxyProvider` plan for the *enforced* version of this: `vscode-copilot-network-egress-redirect-design.md` Section 7.

What's left for genuine enforcement (not just routing) are the non-interception levers already considered (`vscode-copilot-chat-extension.html` Section 8) plus the network-egress redirect hook now being designed:

- **Fork VS Code itself** (core is MIT; the Copilot Chat extension is not) to build an interception layer from scratch. Rejected: replaces a vendor binary instead of configuring one, needs ongoing rebasing against a fast-moving upstream, real distribution/policy cost.
- **Block instead of intercept** -- `chat.disableAIFeatures: true`, or the more durable Windows `AllowedExtensions` registry policy. Real and working today, but stops Copilot Chat from running at all rather than letting policy observe/relay its traffic.
- **Replace with a different extension** -- Continue (proxy-aware, covers autocomplete) or this product's own Claude Code extension (already a proven brokered agent, no autocomplete surface). Neither is a clean swap; both sidestep Copilot Chat rather than intercepting it.
- **Network-egress redirect** (Windows `FWPM_LAYER_ALE_CONNECT_REDIRECT_V4`, macOS `NETransparentProxyProvider`) -- the enforced, kernel/NE-level version that doesn't depend on a user-editable setting. Design in progress: `vscode-copilot-network-egress-redirect-design.md`.

For any customer conversation: the `github-enterprise.uri` mechanism should not be represented as covering the general case -- it's a narrow lever for genuinely GHE-flavored accounts, still unconfirmed against a real one. But `http.proxy` (MDM-pushed) is now a real, working, much cheaper *non-enforced* option for the ordinary-`github.com` population, worth raising as an interim capability alongside the longer-term egress-hook work -- not "block or replace" as the only honest answer anymore.

6. Open items

- [x] Get confirmation on whether a GHE.com tenant exists for Zscaler -- **done, 2026-10-12: confirmed none exists** (Section 3).
- [ ] Confirm whether Zscaler's GitHub Enterprise uses **EMU (Enterprise Managed Users)** -- the one remaining non-dedicated-instance path to a genuine enterprise-flavored sign-in. Follow-up question sent to the admin:

  > Thanks -- that's helpful and answers the GHE.com question cleanly. One more specific question: is Zscaler's GitHub Enterprise using **Enterprise Managed Users (EMU)**? I ask because my own username doesn't have the EMU-style suffix, so I suspect not, but wanted to confirm directly rather than assume.

- [ ] If EMU is confirmed in use, repeat the behavioral test by signing in through that flow for real -- the remaining authoritative version of this test.
- [ ] If EMU is also not in use, `enterprise: true` should be considered **unreachable for Zscaler's own account** via any sign-in flow, not just "unverified" -- re-examine `vscode_copilot.rs`'s shipped `enabled: true` decision in that light.
- [x] Test whether VS Code's `http.proxy` setting routes Copilot CAPI traffic -- **done, 2026-10-13: confirmed yes**, including a real `/chat/completions` call (Section 5 item 5). Tested in compliance with the admin's pilot-scope note, using a pass-through (non-MITM) proxy and no proprietary repo content.
- [ ] Test whether a CA installed in the system/login keychain lets a real MITM relay terminate that routed traffic (the remaining step between "routes through a proxy" and "fully intercepted").
- [ ] Decide product direction for the ordinary-`github.com` population (Section 5): MDM-pushed `http.proxy` as an interim non-enforced lever, network-egress redirect as the enforced follow-up, or block/replace -- no longer "no option," now a prioritization choice.
- [ ] **Compliance:** any further testing that needs a real Copilot Chat round-trip (not just the discovery call) must happen against a non-IP/open-source repo, per the admin's pilot-scope note (Section 3).

Sources

- Choosing your enterprise's plan for GitHub Copilot
- GitHub Copilot allowlist reference
- Configure network settings for Copilot
- `vscode-copilot-enterprise-gate-account-test.md` (this folder's parent)
- `vscode-copilot-licensing-matrix.pdf` (this folder's parent)
- `ISSUES.md` (this folder) -- Issue 6, the `BYPASS_HOSTS` feature itself